FIREFLIES.AI

STEP 4

Experience Design, Mini PRD & Prototype Plan

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Product Management Launchpad Capstone

Product direction: make commitment ownership and closure explicit—without adding a second project-management system.

1. Executive Decision

Build and test a focused commitment-closure workflow inside Fireflies. The MVP should make it clear who has accepted responsibility, what state a commitment is in, and whether it has genuinely reached a terminal outcome.

MVP decision	Product definition
Core solution 1	Owner-confirmed handoff: a suggested owner can accept, decline, or request clarification. A suggested name is not a confirmed owner.
Core solution 2	Explicit resolution: Done and Deliberately dropped are terminal outcomes. Reassignment counts only after the proposed new owner accepts.
Supporting capability	Manual task creation lets users capture work that is missing or needs to be added. It supports the lifecycle but is not a third core solution.
Non-goal	Do not build a full project-management platform, a manager-surveillance dashboard, or unverified external integrations.
Primary outcome	Increase the 14-day commitment resolution rate. The case-study baseline is 28% and target is 45% within six months; achieving that target is not yet demonstrated.

What this report decides—and what remains a hypothesis

The report defines the proposed MVP behavior and how to test it. It does not claim that research has established ownership confusion as the dominant cause of unresolved commitments, nor that the prototype has proven an improvement in resolution.

Product thesis

If Fireflies makes ownership acceptance and terminal outcomes easy to understand and record, users may be better able to carry commitments from meeting discussion to verifiable closure. This is a testable hypothesis, not a proven impact claim.

2. Problem, Evidence, and Design Principles

Problem statement

For teams that make commitments in meetings, the transition from spoken agreement to a verifiable outcome can be difficult to follow across tools and handoffs. When the action, willing owner, expected outcome, and final status are not connected, people may need to reconstruct context and chase updates manually.

Evidence boundary

The interviews provide directional examples of manual follow-up, task tracking across tools, dependency delays, and uncertainty in how work is carried forward. However, several examples do not trace a clearly agreed meeting commitment through its final outcome. The evidence therefore supports investigating continuity and closure, but does not prove prevalence or isolate one dominant root cause.

Design principles

- Consent before assignment: an extracted or selected person is not treated as responsible until acceptance is recorded.
- Explicit over inferred: never count silence, elapsed time, or a manager viewing a task as resolution.
- Honest terminal states: Done, Deliberately dropped, and accepted reassignment count as resolved under the case-study definition.
- Blocked is not done: Blocked, Waiting, and Reassignment pending remain unresolved.
- Minimal workflow: keep actions close to the existing Fireflies experience and avoid duplicating a full task-management tool.
- Trust by design: make state changes visible without individual surveillance scores or punitive nudges.
- Prototype honesty: distinguish simulated behavior and local state from production persistence, file upload, and external integrations.

3. MVP Scope and Prioritization

Priority	Capability	Why it belongs / boundary
P0 — Core	Explicit status model and terminal resolution actions	Directly operationalizes the outcome definition and makes closure measurable.
P0 — Core	Owner confirmation: accept / decline / clarify	Tests whether explicit acceptance makes responsibility clearer without unacceptable friction.
P0 — Core	Reassignment pending → accepted	Prevents handoff initiation from being misreported as completed transfer.
P1 — Supporting	Commitment context and related meeting	Helps users recognize what was agreed; show only data actually available.
P1 — Supporting	Manual task creation	Captures missing work; keep optional fields optional and ownership semantics consistent.
P1 — Supporting	Blocked / Waiting states	Preserves honest non-terminal status and exposes dependency friction.
Later / validate first	Automated reminder orchestration	Potentially useful, but could add notification burden; validate timing and value before broad rollout.
Later / validate first	Deep integrations and team-level analytics views	More effort and dependencies; not necessary to test the core lifecycle hypothesis.

MVP guardrails

- No automatic assignment based solely on extraction confidence or name mention.
- No mandatory due date when one was not agreed.
- No auto-resolution based on inactivity.
- No broad integration promise until a specific integration and data contract are scoped.
- No claim that adding a link or attachment label means the file itself is uploaded, parsed, or durably stored.

4. Lifecycle and State Model

State	Entry condition	Allowed next step(s)	Resolved?
Needs owner confirmation	A commitment has a proposed owner, but acceptance is absent.	Accepted → In progress; Declined / Clarification requested → Review; remain pending.	No
In progress	An owner has accepted responsibility.	Done; Blocked; Waiting; Reassignment pending; Deliberately dropped.	No
Blocked	Work cannot progress because of an identified blocker.	In progress; Waiting; Reassignment pending; Done only when actually complete; Deliberately dropped.	No
Waiting	Work depends on a response, input, or external event.	In progress; Blocked; Reassignment pending; Done when actually complete; Deliberately dropped.	No
Reassignment pending	Current owner or authorized participant proposes a new owner.	Accepted → Reassigned; Declined / no response → remain pending or return to prior owner for review.	No
Done	Authorized user explicitly records completion.	Terminal for this lifecycle; reopening behavior must be specified before production.	Yes

Deliberately dropped	Authorized user explicitly records that the commitment is no longer required.	Terminal for this lifecycle; preserve reason if provided.	Yes
Reassigned	New owner explicitly accepts the handoff.	New owner continues as active owner; retain transfer history.	Yes for transfer event under the case-study definition

Important semantic distinction

The case study defines reassignment as a resolution event, but operationally the work may continue under the new owner. The product should therefore preserve both facts: the original commitment's handoff has been resolved, while the work item remains active for the accepting owner. Analytics must define whether the 14-day outcome is measured at the accepted transfer event or only at final work completion; the case-study definition indicates accepted reassignment counts, so the primary metric should follow that definition and report terminal-state breakdowns separately.

Required transition rules

- A proposed owner remains visibly unconfirmed until they accept.
- Decline or clarification does not create an accepted assignment; route the item back for review.
- Reassignment is not complete when proposed; it becomes Reassigned only after acceptance.
- Blocked and Waiting are non-terminal regardless of age.
- Done and Deliberately dropped must be separately recorded, not merged into a generic Completed state.
- Store who made the change and when, at minimum, for status and ownership transitions.

5. Mini PRD

Target users and jobs

User	Job to be done	Product implication
Meeting participant / creator	Turn a discussion point into an accurate, trackable commitment.	Review wording and context; correct the proposed action or owner.
Suggested owner / IC	Know what is being asked and decide whether to take responsibility.	Accept, decline, or clarify without being silently assigned.
Current owner	Keep the commitment state honest as work progresses.	Update status, record blockers, finish, drop, or initiate a handoff.
Manager / team lead	Understand whether commitments are progressing and where dependencies exist.	Provide status visibility without individual surveillance scores.
Admin / buyer	Evaluate whether the workflow is adopted and useful.	Use aggregate outcomes and guardrails; advanced admin analytics are not MVP-critical.

User stories

- As a meeting participant, I want to review a commitment and its source context so I can correct extraction errors before action is taken.
- As a suggested owner, I want to accept, decline, or ask for clarification so that responsibility reflects an actual agreement.
- As an owner, I want to mark a commitment Done or Deliberately dropped so that its final state reflects reality.
- As a current owner, I want to propose reassignment and see whether the new owner accepted so the handoff is not falsely shown as complete.
- As a user, I want to mark a commitment Blocked or Waiting without being forced to misrepresent it as complete.
- As a user, I want to create a task manually when a commitment was missed by extraction or needs to be captured later.

Functional requirements and acceptance criteria

ID	Requirement	Acceptance criteria
FR-01	Context display	Detail view shows commitment title, available source/meeting context, owner state, current status, and any recorded due

		date or completion criteria. Missing data is not fabricated.
FR-02	Owner confirmation	A proposed owner can Accept, Decline, or Request clarification. Before acceptance, UI labels the owner as Proposed / Awaiting confirmation.
FR-03	Decline / clarification	A decline or clarification response leaves the commitment unresolved and routes it to a visible review state; it does not silently reassign.
FR-04	Reassignment	Initiating transfer displays Reassignment pending. It becomes Reassigned only after the proposed new owner accepts. Decline does not count as resolution.
FR-05	Done	An authorized user can explicitly mark Done. The UI records the actor and timestamp and does not infer completion from inactivity.
FR-06	Deliberately dropped	An authorized user can explicitly drop a commitment. An optional reason may be captured. Analytics distinguish dropped from done.
FR-07	Non-terminal states	Blocked and Waiting remain unresolved in UI and metric logic. They can transition to a terminal state only through an explicit valid action.
FR-08	Manual creation	User can create a task with a required title and optional description, assignee, due date, priority, related meeting, completion criteria, notes, and supporting links/attachment metadata.
FR-09	Validation	Empty title prevents save; inline error identifies the issue; entered values remain after validation failure.
FR-10	Action feedback	Successful status changes show the resulting state and confirmation; failure or unavailable action is communicated without silently losing edits.
FR-11	Responsive layout	At a 390px viewport, task title, current state, and primary action remain usable without horizontal page overflow.
FR-12	Truthful capability labels	Prototype does not imply actual file upload, durable server storage, or external sync unless those capabilities are implemented and verified.

Manual task creation: field policy

Field	Policy	Reason
Title	Required	Minimum information needed to identify the task.
Description / context	Optional	Adds clarity without making entry burdensome.
Assignee	Optional; acceptance required where workflow treats assignment as a commitment	Do not manufacture agreement.
Due date	Optional	Avoid inventing a deadline that was not agreed.
Priority	Optional	Useful operational metadata; not necessarily part of the meeting agreement.
Related meeting	Optional	Connects the task to a source where available.

Completion criteria	Optional	Can clarify what Done means.
Notes	Optional	Supports additional context.
Links / attachment metadata	Optional	Treat as reference metadata unless upload and storage behavior are verified.

6. Experience Flows

Flow A — Extracted commitment

1. Commitment appears with its meeting context and a Proposed owner label.
2. Participant reviews or edits the action and available completion criteria.
3. Suggested owner accepts, declines, or requests clarification.
4. Acceptance changes ownership to confirmed and moves the commitment into an active state; decline/clarification returns it to review.
5. Owner updates progress, records Blocked/Waiting, marks Done, deliberately drops, or initiates reassignment.
6. For reassignment, the item stays pending until the new owner accepts; the history retains the handoff.

Flow B — Resolve or deliberately drop

7. User opens the item and reviews current state and context.
8. User chooses Done, Deliberately dropped, or Reassign; Blocked/Waiting remain available when work is not complete.
9. For Deliberately dropped, capture an optional reason and make the distinct state visible.
10. For Reassign, show pending acceptance until the proposed new owner responds.
11. Update the task list and detail view to show the new state and retain a basic change history.

Flow C — Manual task creation

12. User selects Add Task and enters a title.
13. User optionally adds context, owner, due date, priority, related meeting, completion criteria, notes, or reference links.
14. Form validates required fields and preserves input on error.
15. On save, the item appears in the task list and can be reopened.
16. If an assignee is selected, the UI must not imply they accepted unless the prototype explicitly records that acceptance.

7. Prototype Validation Plan

Research questions

Hypothesis to test	Method	Evidence to capture	Decision informed
Users can distinguish proposed from accepted ownership.	Give participants a task with an unconfirmed owner and ask what happens next.	Correct interpretation, hesitation, errors, confidence.	Keep, simplify, or redesign confirmation labels and actions.
Explicit terminal states improve comprehension of honest closure.	Ask participants to resolve one completed item and one cancelled item.	Whether they choose Done vs Deliberately dropped and explain the difference.	Keep distinct controls or revise language.
Accepted handoff is understandable.	Ask participant to reassign to a colleague who has not responded.	Whether they understand transfer remains pending.	Revise status and notification language.
Blocked / Waiting prevent false completion.	Present a dependency delay and ask for a status update.	Whether they choose a non-terminal state.	Refine state labels and helper text.
Manual creation is usable without distracting from the core workflow.	Ask participant to create a task with only a title, then with optional context.	Completion, time, skipped fields, confusion.	Keep fields optional or reduce the form.
The UI works on a narrow screen.	Run core tasks at 390px width.	Overflow, clipped controls, missed actions.	Fix responsive layout before broader testing.

Suggested usability criteria

For an initial moderated test, use these as decision thresholds—not results: at least 80% of participants complete each critical task without facilitator help; at least 80% correctly explain that Blocked/Waiting and pending reassignment are not resolved; and no participant leaves the test believing a merely proposed owner has accepted responsibility. With a small sample, treat percentages as directional and read them alongside observed errors and participant explanations.

Test sequence

17. Start with unaided task completion; avoid explaining the state model before the task.
18. Ask participants to explain what they believe the current state means.
19. Probe where they hesitated, what they expected to happen next, and whether any status felt misleading.
20. Separate interface comprehension problems from product-policy disagreements.
21. Revise the prototype and retest the highest-risk transitions before expanding scope.

8. Metrics and Instrumentation

North Star

14-day commitment resolution rate = eligible commitments explicitly resolved within 14 days of the defined cohort start ÷ all eligible commitments in that cohort. Count Done, Deliberately dropped, and accepted reassignment according to the case-study definition. Do not count silence, Blocked, Waiting, or pending reassignment.

Critical measurement decision

Before implementation, define the cohort start timestamp consistently—for example, when a commitment is first created/recorded—and document eligibility, duplicate handling, edits, reopened items, and treatment of commitments created before launch. Do not change the definition mid-experiment. Because accepted reassignment counts as resolution under the case-study definition, report resolution type separately so an increase in handoffs is not mistaken for more work completed.

Event	Minimum properties	Question answered
commitment_created	commitment_id, source_type, created_at, related_meeting_present	What enters the eligible cohort?
owner_confirmation_requested	commitment_id, proposed_owner_id, timestamp	How often does a commitment need acceptance?
owner_confirmation_responded	commitment_id, response, timestamp	Do proposed owners accept, decline, or ask for clarification?
commitment_status_changed	commitment_id, prior_status, new_status, actor_role, timestamp	How does the lifecycle progress?
reassignment_requested	commitment_id, proposed_owner_id, timestamp	How often is a handoff initiated?
reassignment_accepted	commitment_id, new_owner_id, timestamp	When does ownership transfer actually complete?
commitment_dropped	commitment_id, reason_present, timestamp	Are dropped commitments recorded honestly and distinctly?
blocker_recorded	commitment_id, blocker_type_if_collected, timestamp	Where does work stall?
manual_task_created	task_id, related_meeting_present, optional_fields_used	Does manual capture support the core workflow?

Supporting metrics and guardrails

Metric	Purpose / guardrail
Owner acceptance rate and time to acceptance	Check whether the confirmation step is usable or creates a new bottleneck.
Share of commitments with no confirmed owner	Expose unresolved ownership rather than hiding it.

Resolution-type mix: Done / Dropped / Reassigned	Prevent a headline metric from concealing the nature of closure.
Blocked / Waiting share and age	Show unresolved dependency burden; do not penalize users for honest status reporting.
Decline and clarification rate	Detect poor extraction, wrong ownership suggestions, or unclear requests.
Reminder dismissals / notification opt-outs (if reminders are implemented)	Guard against overload and trust erosion.
Core workflow abandonment / time to update	Ensure closure improvements do not come from adding excessive work.

Collect only the event data needed to evaluate the workflow. Avoid unnecessary meeting content, sensitive notes, or individual performance scoring. Any business-impact claim should be based on measured changes in resolution and an explicit link to retention, activation, or other business outcomes—not inferred from prototype usability alone.

9. Dependencies, Risks, and Non-Goals

Risk / dependency	Mitigation or product response
Ownership confirmation adds friction.	Measure acceptance rate and time; test whether confirmation is needed for every item or only uncertain assignments.
Users mark Done just to clear a list.	Keep Done separate from Deliberately dropped and Blocked/Waiting; test realistic cases.
Handoff is counted before acceptance.	Use a separate Reassignment pending state and emit the resolution event only on acceptance.
Reminders feel intrusive.	Do not make broad automated reminders part of the MVP; test restrained, contextual prompts separately.
Manager visibility becomes surveillance.	Avoid individual activity scores and punitive ranking; focus on commitment state and blockers.
Manual creation expands scope into task management.	Keep it supporting and validate whether it improves capture of real commitments.
Prototype implies production capability.	Label local-only state and reference metadata honestly; do not claim persistent storage, real upload, or integrations.
Status history is missing.	Production implementation needs reliable actor/timestamp history to support trustworthy state changes and measurement.

Dependencies

- Existing commitment extraction and task surfaces, subject to verification in the actual Fireflies product.
- Stable commitment identifiers and a status-change history.
- Defined permissions for status changes and reassignment.
- Consistent event instrumentation and cohort rules.
- A notification capability only if reminder experiments are later approved.

Explicit non-goals

- Transcription infrastructure or extraction-model development.
- Security architecture or pricing redesign.
- A full project-management platform.
- Unscoped deep integrations with Jira, Slack, email, or other tools.
- Claims that local prototype state represents production persistence.

10. Decision Log and Open Questions

Decision	Rationale	Open question / validation
Owner confirmation is a core solution.	Protects consent and makes ownership state explicit.	Does its benefit justify the extra step?
Explicit resolution controls are a core solution.	Makes outcomes observable and supports deliberate dropping.	Will users use honest statuses consistently?

Accepted reassignment counts as resolution under the case-study definition.	Preserves the supplied outcome definition.	How should dashboards separately show handoff resolution versus work completion?
Manual task creation is supporting scope.	Captures missed work without turning the product into a generic task manager.	How often is manual capture necessary, and for which users?
Automated reminders are deferred from the MVP.	Avoids premature notification burden.	Which trigger, timing, and audience—if any—show net value in testing?
Advanced integrations and team analytics are deferred.	Reduces scope and keeps the first test focused.	Which integration or aggregate view is most requested by target users?

11. Release Gate

Do not treat the MVP design as ready for broader rollout until the following are true:

- Users understand proposed versus accepted ownership.
- Done, Deliberately dropped, Blocked/Waiting, and Reassignment pending are correctly distinguished.
- Reassignment cannot count as resolved before acceptance.
- Manual task creation validates required inputs and preserves user-entered values on error.
- Core flows work on desktop and narrow mobile screens.
- Prototype limitations are documented; production implementation has an explicit persistence and event-tracking plan.
- Metric eligibility and cohort start rules are agreed before an experiment begins.

12. Conclusion

The Step 4 direction is deliberately narrow: make ownership acceptance and commitment closure explicit inside Fireflies, with manual task creation as a supporting entry point. The design protects honest outcomes by keeping blocked work and pending handoffs unresolved, while allowing Done, Deliberately dropped, and accepted reassignment to be recorded distinctly.

The next decision should be based on observed usability evidence and instrumented behavior. The 45% 14-day resolution target is the intended outcome to evaluate—not a guaranteed consequence of this design.